



Phase 1 Proposal

Quality Framework Implementation

CORINTIS SA · AUREA FORGE

Prepared for **Corintis leadership**

Erick Polato · epolato@aureaforge.com · 12 August 2026

Valid for 30 days

PURPOSE

What Phase 1 delivers

Phase 0 diagnosed the engineering organization and produced a prioritized roadmap of 14 actions across three waves. **Phase 1 turns that roadmap into working practice.**

The engagement model is unchanged from Phase 0 and it is deliberate: **Aurea Forge acts as architect and steward, not as an execution team.** I design the frameworks, set the standards, coach the engineers who implement them, and review what comes back. Corintis always owns the execution and the result, which is what makes the improvement permanent rather than dependent on an external party.

The billable work is design, coaching and review. Implementation hours belong to the Corintis team. For example, enforcing the existing quality gate is a one-line configuration change: my contribution is the gate policy, the required-check standard across repositories, and verifying the result, not typing the line.

OPTIONS

Three levels of engagement

All three follow the same wave sequence from the diagnostic, so nothing is wasted if Corintis starts small and extends later. Option B is the recommended scope.

OPTION A

Quick wins

Wave 1 only

~€5,000

6 weeks · 8 h/week · ~48 h

Enforced quality gates, repository protection, secret scanning, platform runbooks, single intake with the interim Product Owner.

Ends with: the cheap risks closed and a working gate policy.

OPTION B · RECOMMENDED

Foundation

Wave 1 + Wave 2 (headcount-independent)

~€21,000

4 months · 12 h/week · ~204 h

Everything in A, plus the **ASME V&V 20 validation programme design**, the quality KPI framework and first leadership dashboard, the ISO 9001 software QMS documentation, and the operating model with definitions of ready and done.

Ends with: a quality system that can be shown to a customer auditor.

OPTION C

Full transformation

Waves 1 and 2 complete, Wave 3 started

~€42,000

8 months · 12 h/week · ~408 h

Everything in B, plus **onboarding the new hires** into the framework, full V&V 20 programme execution, complete DORA instrumentation, release discipline and the QA function enabled with AI tooling.

Ends with: the organization running the system without me.

Recommendation: Option B. It covers the two items with the highest commercial return, the enforced gates and the V&V 20 validation programme, and it completes the ISO 9001 documentation that is already in progress with the quality organization. It also fits the team's real absorption capacity: more consulting hours would outrun what the current engineering headcount can implement, which is the central constraint the diagnostic identified.

SCOPE

Workstreams by option

WORKSTREAM	A	B	C
Quality gate policy and required checks across repositories	•	•	•
Repository protection and secret-scanning standard	•	•	•
Platform runbooks and knowledge-transfer plan (continuity without hiring)	•	•	•
Single intake and demand classification with the interim Product Owner	•	•	•
Definitions of ready and done, merge and review policy	-	•	•
ASME V&V 20 validation programme: methodology, acceptance criteria, uncertainty quantification approach, documentation home	-	design	design + run
Quality KPI framework (GQM tied to the 2026 goals) and first leadership dashboard	-	•	•
ISO 9001 software QMS documentation, process map and internal-audit support	-	•	•
Test strategy for the billing and compute-critical services	-	•	•
Onboarding new engineering hires into the framework	-	-	•
Full DORA instrumentation, incident log, release discipline	-	-	•
QA function enablement with AI-leveraged tooling	-	-	•

COMMERCIALS

Rates, tooling and travel

ITEM	RATE	NOTES
Consulting, remote	€100 / hour	Design, coaching, review and working sessions. Rate held for the full duration of Phase 1.
On-site day	€800 / day	Flat day rate (equivalent to 8 hours). Travel time is not billed.
Travel and accommodation	at cost	Economy fare and standard accommodation, receipted, pre-approved per trip before booking. Travel is ad hoc and proposed against a milestone, for example a kickoff workshop or a results session.
AI tooling	up to €150 / month	Claude usage for the AI-leveraged delivery method, billed at cost with usage evidence. Reduces to zero if Corintis provides a licence covering Sonnet 5 and Opus 5.

On the tooling line, a point worth noting. If Corintis provides the licence rather than reimbursing usage, the work runs inside Corintis's own tenancy, which means Corintis controls data retention on its own source code. Given the IP sensitivity of the solver and the customers being targeted, that is the preferable arrangement on both cost and confidentiality grounds.

TERMS

Approval and invoicing

The commercial structure is designed so that Corintis carries no lock-in and can stop at any month boundary.

- **Scope and estimate are agreed per phase.** The option selected sets the workstreams, the hour envelope and the expected duration.
- **Continuation is approved monthly.** At the end of each month we review what was delivered and Corintis decides whether the next month proceeds. No notice period and no penalty for stopping.
- **Invoicing is monthly, against hours actually worked**, capped at the agreed weekly commitment. Unused hours are not billed and do not roll over. Payment terms 30 days.
- **The hour envelope is a ceiling, not a target.** If a month needs fewer hours, fewer hours are billed.
- Any work beyond the agreed envelope is proposed and approved in writing before it starts.

Indicative monthly run rate for Option B: approximately **€5,350 per month** (52 hours plus tooling), for four months. That is the figure to plan against; the total is simply that envelope, and it shrinks if a month is lighter or if Corintis stops earlier.

BASIS

Assumptions

- Read and write access to repositories, CI dashboards and planning tools continues, under the existing mutual NDA.
- A named Corintis counterpart per workstream, with the Head of Software Engineering as overall owner. **Execution capacity on the Corintis side is the binding constraint**, so the hour envelope assumes the team can absorb roughly one and a half days of guided work per week.
- A weekly working session of about 90 minutes with the engineering lead, plus asynchronous review between sessions.
- The V&V 20 workstream assumes access to a computational engineer at roughly half time for the methodology and baseline work. That effort sits with Corintis and is not part of this budget.
- Options B and C assume the hiring situation continues to improve as indicated. If hiring stays frozen, the headcount-dependent items in Option C are deferred and the envelope reduces accordingly rather than being spent elsewhere.

NEXT STEP

To proceed

Select an option and confirm the start date. The first month begins with a scoping session to sequence the workstreams against the team's current commitments, so that Phase 1 does not compete with the cold-plate performance work the business is measured on.